6. A committee of directors would need to identify the infrastructural upgrades required.
7. Premature increase of speed before these upgrades were put in place would be a misadventure, leading to accidents and other safety concerns. [136]

Responses

1. Two years of detailed instrumented field trials by the RDSO team had established that our bridges and signalling systems were capable of permitting higher speeds with WDM4 class diesel-electric locomotives and Integral Coach Factory (ICF) all coil bogies.
2. Improved system of maintenance based upon track geometry would compensate for deficiencies in track structure.
3. Improvement in the braking system and the provision of additional distant signals would take care of the signalling deficiencies.
4. Periodic track monitoring by oscillograph cars and track recording cars would ensure consistency in track geometry round the year.
5. Need for capital investments was obviated through human efforts. This was a significant departure in approach from the rest of the world.

Banerji recollects, 'The proof of the pudding is in eating it. We ran a shadow express for six months after the technical trials, and studies were successfully completed. This established the operational feasibility of increasing speeds. The prophets of doom were proved wrong. We were mad, motivated and bursting with passion to implement the introduction of the Rajdhani Express. We convinced the government that it was not an elitist idea but a poor man's high speed dream train. Finally, our madness and passion won the day. This is what I can recall.' [137]

Such is the fascinating story of the first fully air-conditioned Rajdhani Express between New Delhi and Howrah, which was introduced on 1 March 1969 at a speed of 120 kmph without any additional investment, except for the cost of the train and its coaches.

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[128] S.M. Imamul Haque, 'An Analysis of Regrouping of Indian Rlys,' *The Impact of Regrouping on the Efficiency of Indian Railways* (Aligarh Muslim University, 1988), chap.3.